

CLIENT QUALIFICATION

Qualifying your client's wants and needs is the most important step in satisfying your client. To help you in this important step, we've put together the following list of questions and tips to help you best qualify your client. We have used a cruise as an example here but these questions can be adapted to fit nearly any type of travel planning.

“When are you looking to cruise?” Get a specific date, date range, or season. Also, find out if they are flexible on the date range.

“How long of a cruise would you like to do? 3, 4, 5, 7 night or longer?” How flexible are they? Better rates, categories, and amenities may be available.

How many passengers will be cruising and what are their ages?” Discounts are available for seniors and children. Find out how they will be divided between cabins (doubles, triples, quads, etc.)

“Where are you looking to go?” Bahamas, Eastern/Western/Southern Caribbean, Alaska, Europe, Panama, Transatlantic, Mediterranean, etc. Ask *why* they want to go to particular islands/attractions.

“How many cruises have you taken and on which lines?” If they have cruised before, find out what kind of cabin they had, what they liked/disliked, etc. Get a feel for the product best suited to your client and to see if they are qualified for any past passenger discounts.

“Are you looking for the most reasonably priced cabin?” Also ask about special occasions, time since last vacation, how often they vacation. The goal is to understand their budget.

“Are you looking for an inside, outside, balcony, or suite?” Point out the benefits and features of the better rooms, categories, and locations.

“Are you flexible as to where you can leave from?” Miami, Port Canaveral, Galveston, etc. This will determine which ships and pre/post options to consider.

“Will you be driving down or making your own arrangements?” Some clients may want to take advantage of cruise line air or "Park & Cruise" hotels which saves the client \$25 per day in parking and avoids the worries of being late.

“Do you have a passport that's valid for at least 6 months after the trip?” While many cruises may allow alternate identification for closed loop sailing, a passport is always recommended and is required for all non-cruise international transportation.

“May I get your email address so that I can email you information regarding your trip?” Getting their email address also allows you to market to them in the future.

“Are you at work or at home? What's the best way/time/place to contact you?” It's important to know when and where to contact your client's and to give the client a reasonable expectation as to what will happen next.

Once you have gathered the above information, it is time to start building the client's excitement. Let them know that you'll be researching the best price on the best cruise for them and that you're working hard to get the best package for them. Be confident: Guarantee your rates! Let them know that you have access to the best resources in the industry, including rates and benefits they cannot find on-line, guaranteed!

